

Irina-Maria Ionita

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PROFILE

Early-career professional with a proactive attitude and experience in policy support, project coordination, and stakeholder engagement. I have strong analytical and communication skills and I am eager to contribute to impact-driven initiatives within an international setting.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

European Commission

Mar. 2026 – Present

Bluebook Trainee Directorate General for Justice and Consumers

- Supported the better regulation team with reviewing Terms of Reference and progress reports
- Coordinated a DG-wide screening exercise of expert groups, collecting inputs from across the DG
- Assisted in the management of access to documents requests

La Strada International (LSI)

Apr. 2024 – Feb. 2026

Researcher | March 2025 – February 2026

- Improved the annual data collection across 26 NGOs by redesigning the survey, creating a timeline and systematising the data gathering process
- Led a working group on the development of National Referral Mechanisms for victims of human trafficking across EU Member States
- Managed the implementation of a multi-partner project on [combating human trafficking for labour exploitation](#) by tracking the budget and timely submission of deliverables

Event Coordinator | July – September 2025

- Organised the [annual General Assembly](#) (40+ participants): managed the logistics budget, and the on-site coordination
- Wrote the activity and donor reports

Research Intern | April 2024 – Feb. 2025

- Conducted mixed-methods research (surveys and interviews) with 10 NGOs to inform policy recommendations on victim identification and protection
- Co-authored 2 case assessment reports on regional anti-trafficking responses
- Developed a policy brief on the identification of victims of human trafficking, synthesising legal and policy findings into clear recommendations.

EDUCATION

Beijing International Chinese College

Feb. – Jun. 2025

- HSK 3 Chinese language course and cultural immersion programme

University of Amsterdam

- BSc Psychology, Social Psychology major
- LLM Public International Law
- BA European Studies, majors in European Law and Eastern European studies

Aug. 2020 – Jan. 2025

Aug. 2022 – Sept. 2025

Aug. 2019 – Sept. 2022

SKILLS

Organisation skills:

- *Strong planning and coordination skills*: ensuring the timely delivery of high-quality outputs for the Trafficked en Route project

Social and Interpersonal skills:

- *Ability to tailor communication* materials to target audiences and institutional priorities
- *Team engagement and cross-team cooperation*: worked across 3 different teams within Unit H1 of DG JUST
- *Conflict mediation and de-escalation*: mediated conflicts between clients and contractors for a year as a customer service agent

Quantitative and Qualitative Research and Analysis

- *Data analysis and visualisation in SPSS, JASP, Excel*
- *Structured and semi-structured*
- *Survey design*

Knowledge of Commission tools: Decide, GoPro, Sysper, EASE, Ares

LANGUAGES

- Romanian | native (C2)
- English | full professional proficiency (C2)
- French | limited working proficiency (B1)
- Italian | limited working proficiency (B1)
- Mandarin Chinese | limited working proficiency (B1)

PUBLICATIONS

- [Trafficking in Human Beings - Statistics and Trends \(2024\)](#)
- [Assisting Displaced Persons from Ukraine](#)
- [Trafficking in Human Beings – Statistics and Trends \(2023\)](#)
- [Assessment of the Principle of Non-Punishment](#)

ANCILLARY ACTIVITIES

Present LSI's Non-Punishment report at the UNODC Regional Expert Group Meeting on Forced Criminality (2025)